

RTAM FOUNDATION — USAGE RULES

Quick reference. For the full rationale see `brand-book.md` .

1 · PICKING A WORDMARK

CONTEXT	FILE
Default. Anywhere the bindu reproduces.	rtam-wordmark-sacred-RTAM-dot.svg
Default on dark grounds (charcoal / indigo / photo) — the sacred form with the gold bindu preserved. Transparent overlay, invisible on white.	rtam-wordmark-ivory-golddot.svg
Sacred surface, embossed, foil, single-color gold print.	rtam-wordmark-gold.svg
Single-colour charcoal reproduction (fax, microform, mono print).	rtam-wordmark-charcoal.svg
Dark ground where a second colour (gold) cannot reproduce — all-ivory overlay.	rtam-wordmark-ivory.svg
Bindu cannot reproduce (small sign vinyl, embroidery < 6 cm).	rtam-wordmark-public-RTAM.svg
Devanagari, Sanskritic register (default).	rtam-wordmark-devanagari-pratishthan.svg
Devanagari, common register.	rtam-wordmark-devanagari-faundeshaan.svg
Temple, plain English.	rtam-temple-wordmark-latin.svg
Temple, pronunciation form (Ṛ + ś).	rtam-temple-wordmark-diacritic.svg
Temple, Devanagari.	rtam-temple-wordmark-devanagari.svg

2 · PICKING AN ICON

CONTEXT	FILE
Default plain mark on light grounds (charcoal R, gold bindu).	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-sacred.svg</code>
Dark theme (ivory R, gold bindu).	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-ivory-golddot.svg</code>
Warm / ceremonial all-gold mark on light grounds.	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-gold.svg</code>
Single-colour charcoal (mono print, stamps).	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-charcoal.svg</code>
App icon / avatar needing a visual frame.	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-circle-gold.svg</code>
Framed icon, single-colour charcoal.	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-circle-charcoal.svg</code>
Framed icon on dark / ceremonial grounds — all gold.	<code>rtam-rdot-icon-circle-allgold.svg</code>
Browser tab, light chrome (≤ 64 px).	<code>favicon.svg</code>
Browser tab, dark chrome (≤ 64 px).	<code>favicon-dark.svg</code>
Anywhere above 64 px — favicon's bindu detaches at scale.	full R-monogram, not the favicon
Devanagari-first contexts.	<code>rtam-devanagari-ri-icon-*.svg</code>

3 · PICKING A LOCKUP

CONTEXT	FILE
Default bilingual (website footer, certificate, letterhead).	<code>rtam-bilingual-foundation.svg</code>
Scholarly / sacred / trust deed.	<code>rtam-sanskritic-pratishthan.svg</code>
Temple signage, donor materials.	<code>rtambhareshvara-mandir-lockup.svg</code>
Temple lockup on dark grounds (event banners, night signage).	<code>rtambhareshvara-mandir-lockup-ivory-golddot.svg</code>
Donation receipts, fundraising pages, contribution forms.	<code>donation-lockup.svg</code>

4 · COLOR RULES

- Default ground: **ivory** (`#F7F3E9`).
- Sacred ground: **indigo** (`#1C1A3D`).
- Body text: **charcoal** (`#1A1A1A`).
- Bindu and rules: **gold** (`#C8A15A`) — decorative only. Gold on ivory is 2.18:1, below AA; never body or UI text on ivory. (An AA-passing functional accent is under study — until it ships, functional text and CTAs on ivory are charcoal.)
- **Stone gray** (`#B8B1A4`) is decorative-only on ivory (1.92:1): dividers, oversized folios — never text that must be read. Shipped assets no longer set stone as text; for quiet copy use charcoal at light weight (the donation lockup's pattern).
- The wordmark **MUST** work in single-colour charcoal `#1A1A1A` — this is the reproduction floor. Charcoal on ivory is 15.7:1 (AAA).
- File-name legend (v2, token-truthful): `-ivory` = ivory, `-charcoal` = charcoal, `-garbhagriha` = bhasma ash on mahakala, `-golddot` = gold bindu preserved on a two-tone mark.

5 · TYPE RULES

- Display Latin: **Cinzel** 400–700.

- Devanagari: **Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit** (regular).
- Body / UI: **Inter** 300–600.
- Pair Cinzel with Tiro Devanagari Sanskrit. Never pair either with a third display face.
- For headlines: Cinzel 500 with letter-spacing 0.04–0.10 em depending on size.
- For all-caps labels (kickers, metadata): Inter 300, letter-spacing 0.20–0.40 em.

6 · CLEAR-SPACE

- **Wordmark**: clear-space = cap-height of R on every side (≈ 84 viewBox units in the 1080×240 canonical — the measured Cinzel cap-height, not the font-size).
- **R-monogram, ऀ-monogram**: clear-space = $\frac{1}{4}$ of icon width.
- **Temple lockup**: preserve the full 1280×380 viewBox — no cropping, no letter-spacing reduction.

7 · THE BINDU

The bindu is **drawn**, not typed. It is a `<circle>` in the SVG with explicit `cx`, `cy`, and `r`. Do not:

- replace it with the Unicode combining dot below (U+0323),
- shift it independently of the R,
- recolor it independently of the wordmark variant,
- shrink it below `r=10` in the 1080-wide wordmark (it becomes invisible).

Need a different placement? Edit `brand/spec/brand.json` and run `brand/tools/build.sh --write` — never hand-edit the SVG in place. The generator keeps the bindu identical across the whole tree.

Two sanctioned deviations from the placement grammar (and only these): the **circle-enclosed icons** centre the bindu on the canvas axis so the composition sits still inside the ring; the **favicon** enlarges the dot and tightens its gap to survive 16 px tabs. Everything else follows `cy = baseline + 0.233·fs`, `r = fs/12`.

The Devanagari marks (ऀ, ऀतम्...) take **no** bindu — the glyph already carries the vocalic-R.

8 · WHAT NEVER TO DO

- Render the wordmark on a busy photo background.
- Outline, emboss, drop-shadow, or gradient the wordmark.
- Recolor the bindu without recoloring the wordmark to match a variant.
- Use the `public-RTAM` (no-bindu) variant when the bindu would reproduce.
- Use the favicon SVG above 64 px.
- Pair the brand with a competing serif display face.
- Add a tagline directly under the wordmark inside its clear-space.

9 · V2 ADDENDA (2026-07-12 — THE ṚTĀMBHAREŚVARA SYSTEM)

The icon system and substance palette are governed by brand-book §v2. Additional hard rules:

The icon. - Never scale the ṛta-chakra below 48 px — step down the sanctity ladder instead (anāhata for community surfaces, bindu below 48 px). - Never rotate the icon: one petal points due north, always. - Never recolor parts independently: use the four shipped cuts — `rtam-chakra-garbhagriha` (dark surfaces), `-day` (light), `-kanaka` (festival), `-mono` (single-ink) — plus the matching anahata/bindu. - The hub is the only gold inside the icon except in kanaka. Never gild the petals outside the kanaka cut.

Grounds (v2). - Dark surfaces are **mahakala** `#141414` — never indigo (retired 2026-07-12), never pure `#000000`. - Reading surfaces are **chandra** `#EDEBE6` — warmivory grounds and sandstone panels are retired; legacy assets only. - On mahakala: display type gold, body text bhasma; links gold. On chandra: ink text, tāmra links/CTAs; gold is decorative only.

Voices. - Every entity/script voice has a `-garbhagriha` cut for dark surfaces; never place the charcoal cuts on mahakala. - City print leads Devanagari ($\geq 2\times$ its English support line); web leads English.

Favicon. - `favicon.svg` / `favicon-dark.svg` are the **bindu** (since P3.4). Never use a typographic R below 48 px.